

Using Telepresence Robots to Enable Research in Long-Term Care led by Patient Partners

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Background

Researchers in the field of long-term care need to find innovative ways to engage patient and family partners. The patient and family partners with our study provided a skillset and experience that was key to our project. However, COVID-19-related restrictions introduced barriers to the engagement of patient partners.

- By using telepresence robots, we hoped to:
- give users **a sense of presence** in a remote space
 - **create a safe environment** for people living with dementia to participate in research
 - **enable active involvement** in research remotely despite ongoing visitation restrictions due to the COVID-19 pandemic



Methods

We used the telepresence robots for one-on-one interviews and workshops led by patient and family partners in **3** separate projects across **4** LTC homes. We then interviewed all **10** researchers (including patient and family partners), to better understand the robots' effectiveness and any existing barriers.

Results: What did researchers think?

Benefits



Research
Enabler



User-Friendly
Technology



Increased
Engagement

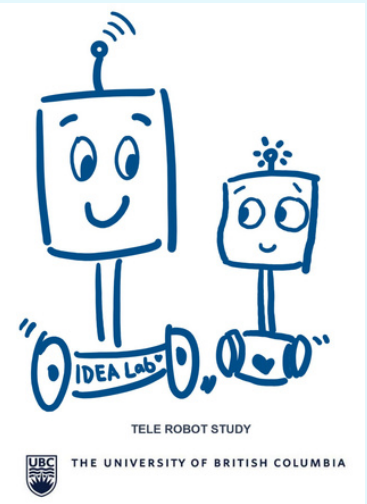
Challenges



Lack of
Infrastructure and
Resources



Training and
technical
obstacles



Our recommendations to implement: ROBOT

- R**ealign to adapt methods
- O**rganize with site champions
- B**lend Strategies
- O**ffer timely technical assistance
- T**ailor training to site/user needs

